

S04-02 - The Hanging Office Exterior

Player read-aloud

A cabin-sized boulder rests below the tree, tied by thick rope to a hanging office above. It blinks with inspection seals and an old warning light.

Scene summary

The Custodian's suspended treehouse-office hangs from an ancient tree.

Visible choices

- Call up
- Climb
- Tamper with counterweight
- Use magic

Player questions

- What detail in The Hanging Office Exterior tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

GM notes

- Let them solve how to get attention. The tree gently stops reckless climbing.
- Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it.
- Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.

Checks and rolls

- Agility Navigate the suspended office safely. Easy to standard Avoid losing time or dignity. 10/15 Cleanly resolve: Navigate the suspended office safely. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to The Hanging Office Exterior. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to expose neglected infrastructure, stress the Custodian, or make the Keystone hum at the wrong moment. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.
- Knowledge Read the office backlog. Standard Expose infrastructure neglect. 15 Cleanly resolve: Read the office backlog. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or

improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to The Hanging Office Exterior. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to expose neglected infrastructure, stress the Custodian, or make the Keystone hum at the wrong moment. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.

Clues

- Inspection-Sealed Counterweight The office is unsafe. Corporate oversight records risk but does not fix it. The office itself is under audit, yet still doing the work.

Loot

- Use Hanging Office search results table

Mechanics

- Plot So Far: The party is in Act Four pressure: The Custodian's suspended treehouse-office hangs from an ancient tree.
- Mechanics In Play: Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting.
- Roll Cards: s04-02-reach-the-hanging-office S04-02 Reach the Hanging Office Reach the Hanging Office Agility Strength Agility Strength 13 Agility climbs; Strength holds rope, ladder, or counterweight. The approach turns comic, hazardous, or disrespectful. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The approach turns comic, hazardous, or disrespectful. Use a...
- Gm Fear Spends: Make neglected infrastructure answer at the wrong moment. Stress the Custodian's trust without turning her into a device.
- Conditions Hazards: Restrained
- Search Loot Clues: No fixed loot. Offer clue, texture, or hospitality only when the fiction supports it.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Escalation: Escalate by making cost visible: time, noise, trust, ward instability, or someone vulnerable in danger.
- Deescalation: De-escalate through respect, care, honest testimony, useful evidence,

or a concrete concession.

- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: The Hanging Office Exterior asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Agility, Finesse, Knowledge, Strength. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength, Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.
- Class Community Ancestry Reveals: Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress. Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.

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